

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

The news coming from Lake Kachanawa is worrying ...



Learning Outcome

Identify and describe events in the news in a range of social and work contexts.

Ask your partner:

- What type of news do you follow regularly? Why?
- What type of news do you usually ignore? Why?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about natural disasters.
- I can talk about international news.
- I can talk about cause and effect and hypothetical situations.





Let's Explore!

If we don't do anything about the lake, it could be **the end of the road*** for many endangered species.

* When you reach "the end of the road" you get to the point beyond which survival cannot continue.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Environmental organizations were horrified by the most recent report on the state of Lake Kachanawa. The pollution levels are unprecedented, and thousands of gallons of hazardous waste materials are being poured into its waters every day.

In recent years, a new type of alga has appeared in the lake. This poisonous parasite was first introduced by the increased amount of noxious bacteria released into the waters. Research was conducted regarding its long-term effect. The results are clear: if we keep the lake in its current state, we will face an ecological disaster of catastrophic proportions. We will witness the death of a natural wonder within our lifetime if we don't change the way we live right now.

To make matters worse, regulations regarding pollution were never properly carried out by any governing body. Although warnings were given to offenders, they were never taken seriously. If the perpetrators were fined or jailed, maybe things would change.

Not enough is being done to protect the waters of Lake Kachanawa. The purity of this beautiful lake was never taken for granted by our ancestors. If they could see us now, they would be appalled by what Lake Kachanawa has become. People will flee and wildlife will perish if we don't safeguard this important water source.





Let's Practice!

Sally explains why environmental organizations were horrified by some recent international news.

Instructions: Read the text again. Select the correct option to complete each statement.

1. This poisonous parasite ...
 - was first introduce by the increased amount of noxious bacteria.
 - were first introduced by the increased amount of noxious bacteria.
 - was first introduced by the increased amount of noxious bacteria.
2. Research ...
 - was conducted regarding its long-term effect.
 - was conducting regarded its long-term effect.
 - was conduct regarding its long-term effect.
3. Although warnings ...
 - were given to offenders, they were never taken seriously.
 - was given to offenders, they were never taken seriously.
 - were give to offenders, they were never taken seriously.
4. The purity of this beautiful lake ...
 - were taken never for granted by our ancestors.
 - was taken never for granted by our ancestors.
 - was never taken for granted by our ancestors.



Let's Practice!

Ecological corrections are needed.

Instructions: Proofread the sentence. Cross out the incorrect words. Rewrite the corrected sentences below. Use capital letters where necessary.

1. Environmental organizations were horrifying by the most recent report on the state of Lake Kachanawa. _____
2. This poineous parasite was first introduced by the increased amount of obnoxious bacteria released into the waters. _____
3. Thousands of gallons of hazzard waste materials are being poured into its waters every day. _____
4. We will face an ecological disaster of photographic proportions. _____
5. People will flee and wildlife will parish if we don't safeguard this important water source. _____





Extension Activity

Write a re-election speech.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- With a partner, brainstorm the types of things that the government does for its people in times of a natural disaster.
- Write down what the government does and then create sentences using the Past Passive.
- Imagine you are the mayor of your city and are running for re-election.
- Discuss what things were done by your government after a huge hurricane hit your city last year.
- Make a speech to the class using the passive voice to talk about the accomplishments.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I talk about natural disasters.

☐ ☐

I talk about local news.

☐ ☐

I talk about cause and effect and hypothetical situations.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **hazardous** (adjective): dangerous; risky
e.g. Gallons of hazardous substances are being poured in the water every day.
- **horrified** (adjective): filled with horror; shocked
e.g. Environmental organizations were horrified by the most recent report on the state of Lake Kachanawa.
- **waste material** (noun): any substance considered worthless or unwanted
e.g. Thousands of gallons of hazardous waste materials are being poured into its waters every day.
- **poisonous** (adjective): capable of causing death or illness if taken into the body
e.g. Poisonous parasites were introduced into the water over the years.
- **alga** (noun): a plant organism found in water
e.g. In recent years, a new type of alga has appeared in the lake.
- **noxious** (adjective): poisonous
e.g. The increased amount of noxious bacteria released into the waters is causing the death of many species.
- **disaster** (noun): an accident that causes great damage and loss of life
e.g. If we keep the lake in its current state, we will face an ecological disaster.
- **catastrophic** (adjective): involving great damage and suffering
e.g. We will face an ecological disaster of catastrophic proportions.
- **to perish** (verb): to die in a violent, sudden way
e.g. People will flee and wildlife will perish if we don't safeguard this important water source.





Learning Points

Simple Past Passive

When you are writing a news article or giving an interview, you can include the Simple Past Passive to describe something done by someone at sometime in the past.

In a regular sentence structure, you use Subject + verb + object.

Example:

Governing bodies never properly carried out regulations regarding pollution.

In the Simple Past Passive form, you use the structure:

Object + *was / were* + past participle + *by* Subject

Example:

Regulations regarding pollution were never properly carried out by any governing body.

Examples:

- *This poisonous parasite was first introduced by the increased amount of noxious bacteria released into the waters.*
- *Research was conducted regarding its long-term effect.*
- *Although warnings were given to offenders, they were never taken seriously.*





Learning Points

Conditional Sentences with *If* Clause

You use the first conditional with *If* clauses to talk about real possibilities in the future.

You use the second conditional to talk about unreal or imaginary (hypothetical) situations in the future.

You use the First Conditional to say it's possible that you will do or not do something. In that condition, something else may, will or will not happen.

The parts of the sentence are divided into two clauses: the *If* clause and the *Condition* clause.

You use the Second Conditional to talk about hypothetical situations. It's not certain that it's possible to fulfill the condition.

Example:

If I had a million dollars, I would buy a car.

Do you have a million dollars? No.

Is it possible to suddenly get a million dollars? Not really.

What would you do if you had a million dollars? Buy a car.

You use the **Simple Past verb + *would***

First Conditional: 1st Clause	First Conditional: 2nd Clause	Meaning
<i>If we keep the lake in its current state,</i>	<i>we will face an ecological disaster of catastrophic proportions.</i>	It's possible that we keep the lake in its current state. In this condition, we will face an ecological disaster.
Second Conditional: <i>If ... + Simple Past</i>	Second Conditional: <i>would + base verb</i>	Result
<i>If the perpetrators were fined or jailed,</i>	<i>maybe things would change.</i>	It is not certain that the perpetrators will be fined or jailed. What would happen if it did? Things would change.

